

FiSH Partner and Investor Strategy

Prodeo Capital, The Prodeo Group

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1. Purpose

This document sets out how Prodeo Capital will scale FiSH, its purpose-built general ledger engine for small and medium businesses, through strategic partners, collaborators, and investors. It covers the Mano River launch (Sierra Leone, Liberia, Guinea, Côte d'Ivoire) and the later ventures the engine will power: Purse, a credit union for the UK, Northern Ireland, and the Republic of Ireland, and an agrifinance expansion in Sierra Leone.

The core idea is simple. Partners get FiSH into businesses' hands cheaply and quickly. Each partnership tier produces proof that makes the next investor conversation easier. Partners and investors are therefore planned together, not separately.

2. Guiding principles

- **Every partner earns its place.** Partners must reduce our cost to reach an SMB, add trust we do not yet have, or supply data and rails we would otherwise build ourselves. If a partner does none of these, it is a distraction.
- **Protect the engine.** FiSH is built from the ground up and owned by the Group. Partnerships must never dilute control of the engine or create dependencies that a partner could withdraw.
- **Concentrate, then expand.** Start where a small number of partners can reach many businesses, then widen.
- **Prove, then raise.** Raise money against what has been demonstrated, not what is planned. Each stage has a clear proof point that unlocks the next investor group.

3. Strategic partners

Strategic partners are organisations with which we intend a formal, ongoing commercial or technical relationship. They fall into three groups.

3.1 Distribution partners: where SMBs already are

Partner type	Examples to approach	What they give us	What we give them
Mobile money operators	Orange Money (SL, Guinea, CI); MTN and Lonestar (Liberia, CI); Africell; Wave (CI)	Merchant base, payment data into the ledger, brand trust	Stickier merchants, richer transaction data, a reason for merchants to stay on their rails
Banks with SMB lending	Ecobank, UBA, GTBank, Rokel Commercial Bank, national banks per country	Access to borrowers, credibility, possible co-branding	Borrowers with real-time books, lower credit risk, faster underwriting
Accountants and bookkeeping firms	Local practices, national accountancy institutes	A sales and support force that SMBs already trust	Certified-partner status, referral revenue share, tools that save them time
Business software resellers and IT firms	Local ICT companies with SMB clients	Installation, training, first-line support	Margin on subscriptions and services

3.2 Credibility and reach partners

Partner type	Examples to approach	Why they matter
Chambers of commerce and SME agencies	SMEDA (Sierra Leone), Liberia SBA equivalent, national chambers in Guinea and CI	Endorsement, member events, access to registered SMBs
Regional bodies	Mano River Union secretariat, ECOWAS SME and trade units	Cross-border positioning; useful for investors and for Purse's Sierra Leone lending
Cooperatives and commodity buyers	Cocoa, cashew, rice and palm cooperatives; exporters and aggregators	Direct route to farmers for agrifinance; buyers can anchor repayment
Sector associations	Traders' unions, market associations, transport and construction bodies	Fast route into high-volume, cash-heavy sectors

3.3 Technical and regulatory partners

Partner type	Examples to approach	Why they matter
Hosting and connectivity	Local data centres, telcos, regional cloud providers	Reliability on low bandwidth; data residency where required
Identity and KYC	National ID programmes, KYC vendors serving West Africa and UK/Ireland	Faster onboarding for FiSH and essential for Purse
Payments and open banking (UK and Ireland)	Payment initiation and account data providers	Purse member transactions and reconciliation into FiSH
Regulators	Central banks in each Mano River country; PRA and FCA (UK); Central Bank of Ireland	Early engagement shortens Purse's authorisation path and signals seriousness to investors

4. Collaborators

Collaborators are lighter-touch relationships: pilots, funding programmes, research, and knowledge. They cost little, build evidence, and often lead to formal partnerships.

- **Development and donor programmes.** Development programmes that fund SME digitisation, such as GIZ, Mastercard Foundation, IFC advisory, and UK-funded programmes in West Africa. They can subsidise onboarding and pay for pilots.
- **Academic partners.** Business schools and universities in Freetown, Monrovia, Conakry, Abidjan, and the UK for pilots, case studies, and training content.
- **Credit union bodies.** ABCUL and the Irish League of Credit Unions for Purse; they know the regulatory path and the member expectations.
- **Agri research.** Agricultural research and extension bodies in Sierra Leone for the agrifinance phase.
- **Ecosystem networks.** Fintech hubs and accelerators in Lagos, Nairobi, Abidjan, and London for visibility and warm investor introductions.

5. Partner outreach plan

5.1 Prioritisation

Score each prospective partner on three questions: How many SMBs can they reach? How much do they lower our cost per customer? How much trust do they lend us? Pursue the highest-scoring three to five partners per country first. Do not run more than two live negotiations per category at once.

5.2 Sequence

Phase	Timing	Focus	Target outcome
Groundwork	Now to FiSH launch	Accountant network, one mobile money operator, one SME agency per launch country	Signed MoUs and a pilot cohort of 50 to 100 SMBs
Launch	First 6 months live	Convert pilots to paying customers; add a bank partner in Sierra Leone	First bank referral agreement; published case studies
Scale	Months 6 to 18	Second mobile money operator, resellers, chambers across all four countries	Partner-sourced customers exceed direct sales
Platform	Month 18 onward	Regulators and credit union bodies for Purse; cooperatives for agrifinance	Purse authorisation underway; first agri lending pilot

5.3 Partner offer

- **For accountants and resellers:** Certified partner programme with tiered revenue share, training, and co-marketing.
- **For mobile money and banks:** API integration, joint go-to-market, and shared data insights under clear data agreements.
- **For chambers and agencies:** Free or subsidised onboarding for their members in return for endorsement and events.
- **For donors and programmes:** Pilot funding in exchange for measured results we can publish.

6. Investor strategy

Investors are approached in stages, each tied to what FiSH can prove at that point. The pitch changes at every stage; the story does not: one engine, built and owned by the Group, powering multiple businesses.

Stage	Proof point	Investor type	Pitch
Stage 1: Pre-launch	Working engine; pilot partners signed	Group capital, angels close to the Group, grant and DFI pilot funding, revenue-based financing where suitable	The vision and the fact that the engine is owned, not rented. Low-cost route to a large, underserved SMB market
Stage 2: FiSH live	Paying SMBs, retention data, partner-sourced growth, unit economics	Africa-focused and impact funds (for example Partech Africa, TLcom, Norrsken22, Launch Africa, Ventures Platform), corporate venture arms of banks and telcos	Traction and the cost of acquiring a customer through partners. Path to profitability in the region
Stage 3: Platform	FiSH profitable or near; Purse authorisation in progress; agrifinance pilot data	DFIs (IFC, British International Investment, AfDB), fintech and financial-inclusion funds, strategic investors	One engine, several regulated businesses. Diversified revenue across accounting, credit union, and agri lending

6.1 Questions investors will ask

Prepare clear answers to each before the first meeting.

- Who owns the intellectual property in FiSH, and how is it protected?
- How do you reach SMBs cheaply in markets with low digital adoption, and what is the cost per customer?
- What is monthly churn, and why do businesses stay?
- What is the regulatory path and timeline for Purse in the UK and Ireland, and what capital does it require?
- Why does one engine serving accounting, a credit union, and agri lending not spread the team too thin?
- What happens if a key distribution partner walks away?
- How do currency risk and political risk across four countries affect returns?

6.2 Investor materials to prepare

- One-page overview in plain language, matching the website messaging.
- Investor deck: problem, product, ownership of the engine, go-to-market through partners, traction, team, roadmap to Purse and agrifinance, the ask.
- Financial model with partner-driven acquisition costs and country-by-country assumptions.
- Data room: IP documentation, partner agreements, pilot results, regulatory correspondence.
- Case studies from pilot SMBs and, later, partner testimonials.

6.3 Investor outreach

- Build a target list of 30 to 40 investors across the three stages, noting who they have backed in West Africa and fintech.
- Use collaborators (accelerators, DFIs, partner banks) for warm introductions; avoid cold outreach where possible.
- Send a short quarterly update to all target investors from now, even before raising, so they see progress over time.
- Open a formal round only once the stage's proof point is met.

7. Timeline at a glance

Period	Partners	Investors
Q3 to Q4 2026	Sign accountant network, first mobile money and SME agency MoUs; recruit pilot SMBs	Group and angel funding; apply for grant and DFI pilot programmes; start quarterly investor updates
H1 2027	FiSH launch; convert pilots; approach first bank partner	Build data room; refine model with live numbers
H2 2027	Expand across all four countries; reseller programme live	Open Stage 2 round with Africa and impact funds
2028	Engage UK and Irish regulators and credit union bodies; cooperatives for agrifinance	Prepare DFI and strategic conversations for Stage 3
2029 onward	Purse launch; agrifinance lending in Sierra Leone	Stage 3 raise on platform economics

8. Risks and how partners help

Risk	Mitigation
Low digital adoption among SMBs	Accountant and reseller partners handle onboarding in person; mobile money integration makes the ledger fill itself
Dependence on a single partner	No exclusivity in distribution; at least two partners per category per country by month 18
Regulatory delay for Purse	Engage regulators and credit union bodies two years ahead; FiSH revenue funds the wait
Investor scepticism about breadth	Sequence launches; show FiSH economics before asking investors to fund Purse or agrifinance
Political or currency shocks in a launch country	Four-country footprint spreads exposure; pricing in local currency with regular review

9. Next steps

- Agree the partner scoring criteria and produce a named target list per country within four weeks.
- Assemble the Stage 1 investor materials and send the first quarterly update.
- Assign an owner for regulator engagement on Purse.

Note: organisation names are examples for outreach planning. Confirm each organisation's current activity and contacts before approaching them.